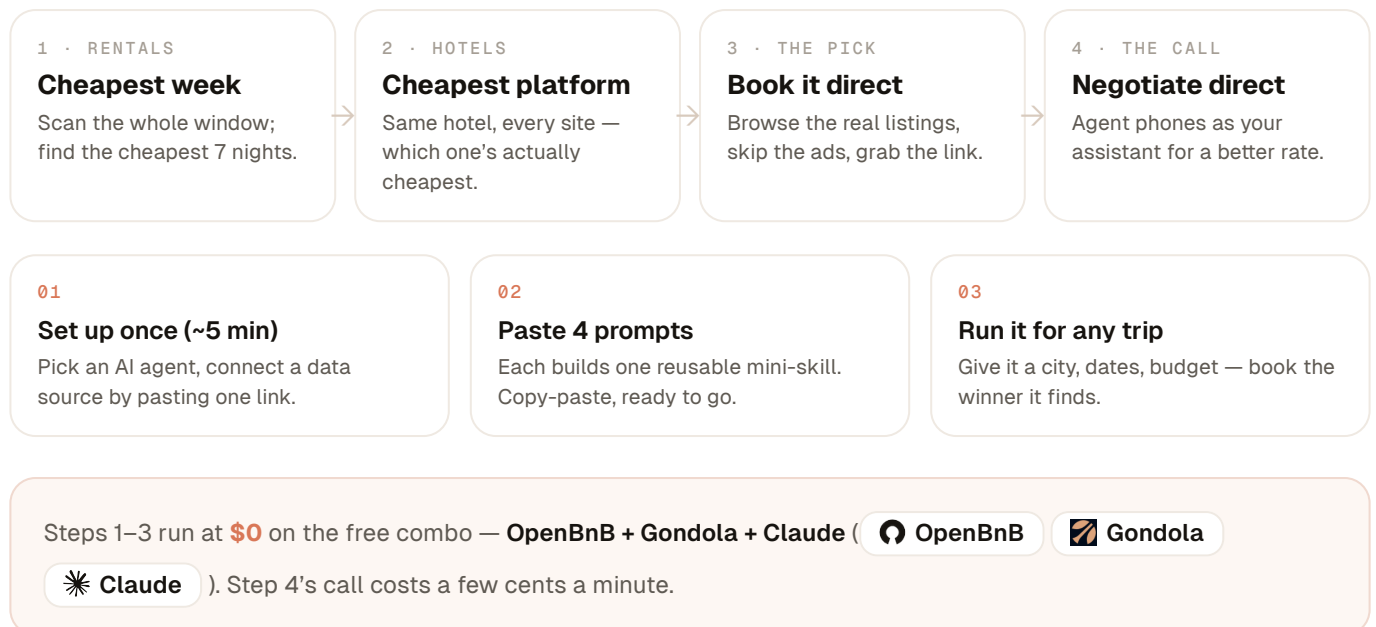


CAN WE JUST BUILD SOME SHIT OURSELVES?

Beat the Booking Sites

Every booking site runs dynamic pricing on you — the same room quietly costs more tomorrow. This is the stack that buys that data back: the **cheapest week to go**, the **cheapest place to book**, and the **direct link** that cuts the middleman out. You connect it once, then just ask.



Pick your agent

You need one AI agent that can (1) connect a data source and (2) browse the web. Every option here does both — pick on budget. The reader picks; there's no wrong answer.



Claude (Cowork / Desktop)
Free • Pro \$20/mo

Best all-round. Connect a data source, then browse listings with Claude for Chrome.



Perplexity Comet
Free • Pro \$20/mo

The browser IS the product. Custom data connectors unlock on Pro.



Manus
Free • Pro from \$20/mo

Built-in Browser Operator, and MCP connectors work on every plan — including free.



ChatGPT
Plus ~\$20/mo

Agent mode browses the web — but it won't use your custom data source in the same run, so do the data step and the browse step separately.



Claude Code
included w/ Claude Pro

The advanced lane: same connectors, one command in your terminal.

CONNECT A DATA SOURCE • ONCE

The universal move: copy a data source's **MCP link** (you'll grab those on the next page) and paste it into your agent's connector settings.

Claude (Cowork / Desktop / web)	Click Customize (the briefcase) → Connectors → + → Add custom connector → paste the link → Add → Connect
Perplexity Comet	Settings → Connectors → + Custom connector → Remote → paste the link → Add
Manus	Add MCP server → name it → Transport HTTP → paste the link
ChatGPT (Plus / Pro)	Settings → Apps & Connectors → Advanced → turn on Developer mode → Create → paste the link
Claude Code	Run <code>claude mcp add --transport http trip <link></code>

Free plans usually allow **one** custom connector — enough to run this whole guide.

Connect your data

Two things to connect: one **rental** source and one **hotel** source. Start free — the top pick in each list needs no key and no signup.

RENTALS · SHORT-TERM STAYS



OpenBnB FREE

Live Airbnb search + real prices. Paste mcp.openbnb.ai/mcp — no key, no signup.



AirROI ~\$10 pay-as-you-go

Real demand curves & occupancy by market — the "cheapest week" data. Paste mcp.airroi.com + your key.



PriceLabs \$14.49/listing/mo

Host-grade market data; needs a host account. Paste mcp.pricelabs.co/mcp.



AirDNA Free dashboard

Deepest STR market data — but the API is enterprise contact-sales, no paste-in.



Key Data Contact sales

Verified reservation data that folds hotels in. Enterprise.

HOTELS



Gondola FREE

Member & direct rates across Marriott, Hilton, Hyatt, IHG + booking links. Paste mcp.gondola.ai/mcp — no key.



SerpApi Free 250/mo · then \$25/mo

Per-site hotel prices pulled from Google Hotels. Uses an API key.



Makcorps 30 free calls · then \$350/mo

The same hotel priced across 200+ booking sites (Expedia included) in one call. API key.



Travelpayouts FREE token

Hotel prices via Hotellook; join the affiliate network for a free token.



Lighthouse Contact sales

The polished, enterprise rate-shopping platform (~\$100/mo+).

The free combo — **OpenBnB + Gondola** — runs the entire guide at \$0. Upgrade only if you want deeper demand data.

Find the cheapest week to go

Prices swing week to week. This skill scans your whole travel window and finds the single cheapest 7-night stretch — plus the best-value neighborhoods.

► PROMPT · PASTE THIS TO YOUR AGENT AS A NEW MESSAGE

Create a new skill called trip-rentals.

To run it I'll give you a city, a travel window (a start and end date), and my max nightly budget — if I leave any of those out, ask me first.

Using my connected rental-data source, price a 7-night stay starting on each day in that window. Report the cheapest 7 nights (start date + total), the most expensive, and the 2–3 neighborhoods with the lowest average nightly price that still have lots of listings.

Save it to a file called trip-plan.md: put CITY, WINDOW and BUDGET at the top, then a "## RENTALS" section with the cheapest week, the full price range, and those neighborhoods. If the file already exists, update those parts instead of duplicating.

Finish by showing me the cheapest week's dates, its total, and the cheapest-to-priciest range.

Run it: "trip-rentals – Lisbon, Oct 1-31, max \$120/night."

- ✓ **You'll know it worked when** your agent creates `trip-rentals`, prints the cheapest week's dates + total + price range, and saves a `trip-plan.md` file.

trip-plan.md · the one file all four skills read & write

CITY: Lisbon

WINDOW: Oct 1-31 BUDGET: \$120/night

RENTALS ← Step 1 fills this in

HOTELS ← Step 2 adds this

THE PICK ← Step 3 adds this

THE CALL ← Step 4 adds this

The skills stay separate on purpose — each one runs, reschedules and gets fixed on its own. They only share this file.

Find the cheapest place to book

The same hotel is priced differently on every site. This finds which one's cheapest, and by how much.

► PROMPT · PASTE THIS TO YOUR AGENT AS A NEW MESSAGE

Create a new skill called trip-hotels.

To run it I'll give you a city, exact check-in and check-out dates, and the names of up to 3 hotels I'm considering — if I don't name the hotels, ask me, never invent them.

For each hotel, use my connected hotel-data source to get the price for the same room type across every booking site it can see, in one currency, including taxes and fees. For each hotel report the cheapest site, its price, and how much that beats the priciest site.

Add a "## HOTELS" section to trip-plan.md with that table. Don't add the three hotels together — I'm only booking one.

Finish by showing me, per hotel, the cheapest booking site and price.

✓ **Worked when** it adds a `HOTELS` section to `trip-plan.md` with the cheapest booking site per hotel.

Let it pick — and book direct

Your agent opens a browser, skips the Sponsored junk, picks the best-reviewed stay in budget, and hands you a clean direct link.

► PROMPT · PASTE THIS TO YOUR AGENT AS A NEW MESSAGE

Create a new skill called trip-pick.

Read the city, dates and budget from trip-plan.md — if a budget line is missing, ask me for it first. Tell me which site you'll search (e.g. Airbnb or Booking) and open it in your browser for that city and those dates.

From the normal results (not anything labelled Sponsored or Ad), keep only stays at or under my nightly budget, then rank them by review score divided by nightly price and shortlist the top 3. Pick the best one and copy its plain listing link — strip any tracking junk off the URL.

Add a "## THE PICK" section to trip-plan.md with your shortlist, your pick and the clean link. To show the difference, also look at the single top Sponsored listing and say why your organic pick beats it.

Finish by showing me your pick, the clean booking link, and why it beats the sponsored one.

✓ **Worked when** `THE PICK` lands in `trip-plan.md` with your winner, a clean booking link, and why it beat the ad.

Have it call and negotiate direct

The last middleman cut: your agent phones the place **as your assistant** and asks for a better rate than the booking site — the thing you'd never bother to do yourself. Connect one calling service, then paste the prompt.



AgentPhone \$3/mo + \$0.13/min

Built-in AI call — closest to "call as my assistant." Paste mcp.agentphone.ai/mcp + key. US/Canada.



Retell AI \$10 free credits · ~\$0.07/min

Remote calling MCP, pay per component. Paste mcp.retellai.com + key.



Vapi \$0.05/min + usage

Most robust paste-in calling MCP. Paste mcp.vapi.ai/mcp + key.



ElevenLabs Agents Free 15 min/mo · \$0.08/min

Best-sounding voice — but its MCP is a local install (needs Python).



Telnyx Usage-based

A real phone carrier; official MCP + one-click Claude connector. More technical.



Bland AI Free tier · \$0.14/min

Cheap bundled per-minute — but its official MCP can't place calls (needs a 3rd-party wrapper).

► PROMPT · PASTE THIS TO YOUR AGENT AS A NEW MESSAGE

Create a new skill called trip-call.

Read THE PICK — the place, its phone number and my dates — from trip-plan.md. If there's no phone number, find it first. Using my connected calling service, phone that place and open with: "Hi, I'm an AI assistant calling on behalf of [my name]." Then ask just three things: is [my dates] available, what's their best rate if I book direct with them instead of the booking site, and whether that rate includes what I care about (I'll tell you — e.g. breakfast, parking). Stay polite, keep it short, and don't commit to booking.

Add a "## THE CALL" section to trip-plan.md with the direct rate they quoted, how it compares to the booking-site price in THE PICK, and their answer on availability.

Finish by showing me the direct quote vs the online price, and whether calling beat it.

⚠ **BEFORE YOU RUN IT** Have it say up front it's an AI, and either turn call recording off or get spoken consent — several US states (incl. California) require both bot disclosure and all-party recording consent.

Your toolkit for this build

Every tool you'll equip in this guide, in one place. Steps 1–3 run at \$0 on the free picks; the paid ones just go deeper. Tap any to open it.

01		Claude AI AGENT	Connect a data source and browse listings. Free, or Pro \$20/mo.	FREE
02		Perplexity Comet AI BROWSER	Agentic browser; custom connectors on Pro \$20/mo.	FREE
03		Manus AI AGENT	Browser Operator + MCP on every plan, including free.	FREE
04		OpenBnB RENTAL DATA	Free live Airbnb search + prices, no key, no signup.	FREE
05		AirROI RENTAL DATA	Demand curves by market. Pay-as-you-go from ~\$10.	~\$10
06		PriceLabs RENTAL DATA	Host-grade market data. \$14.49/listing/mo.	\$14.49/mo
07		Gondola HOTEL DATA	Free member/direct rates + booking links, no key.	FREE
08		SerpApi HOTEL DATA	Per-site hotel prices. Free 250/mo, then \$25/mo.	FREE
09		Makcorps HOTEL DATA	200+ booking sites in one call. Free trial, then \$350/mo.	FREE TRIAL
10		AgentPhone CALLING	AI calls the hotel as your assistant. \$3/mo + \$0.13/min.	FROM \$3/mo
11		Retell AI CALLING	Remote calling MCP. \$10 free credits to start.	\$10 CREDIT
12		Vapi CALLING	The most robust paste-in calling MCP. \$0.05/min + usage.	~\$0.05/min

KEEP BUILDING

I break down a build like this every week.

Free prompts, real stacks, no fluff — the kind of thing booking sites would rather you didn't have. Grab the rest here:

angussewell.com